



Occupational English Test

Writing sub-test

Medicine

August 2014

Please print in **BLOCK LETTERS**

Candidate number

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Family name

Other name(s)

City

Date of test

Candidate's signature

YOU MUST NOT REMOVE OET MATERIAL FROM THE TEST ROOM

The OET Centre

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OCCUPATIONAL ENGLISH TEST

WRITING SUB-TEST: MEDICINE

TIME ALLOWED: **READING TIME: 5 MINUTES**
WRITING TIME: 40 MINUTES

Read the case notes below and complete the writing task which follows.

Notes:

Michael Weir is a patient in your general practice.

Name: Mr Michael Weir (**DOB:** 20 Sep 1970)
Height: 183cm
Background: Smoker
Overweight — long term
Depression — sertraline hydrochloride (Zoloft) since Sep 2012
Married — 3 children (13, 10 & 8yrs)
Real estate agent — reports no time for exercise/relaxation
Active member of local church congregation

Patient History:

29.06.14

Subjective: Here for general check-up. Reports feeling 'run down': tired, stressed, 'sluggish'.
Examination: BP: 96/83, Heart rate (HR): 70bpm
BMI: 27.8 (Wt: 93.1kg)
Chest clear
Skin check — no suspicious lesions found
Tests: CBC, cholesterol/lipids
Plan: R/v in 1wk (discuss test results)

07.07.14

Subjective: Here to receive results of blood tests (cholesterol, CBC)
Still tired, feeling 'down'.
Reports weakness in L leg.
Examination: BP: 90/80, HR: 79 bpm
Chest clear
Sertraline hydrochloride — ongoing
BMI: 28.5 (Wt: 95.5kg)
Test results: Cholesterol: 6.37mmol/L
CBC - low WBC; low RBC, low Hb & Hct; other results in normal range
Assessment: Repeat assessment of hypercholesterolaemia in 3mths.
Monitor general health - tiredness, depressed feelings.
Pt should make lifestyle changes (smoking, diet, exercise, recreation).
Plan: Pt to ↓dietary saturated fat, incorporate regular exercise to ↓weight & cholesterol levels; stop smoking.
R/v in approx 1mth to assess general health, feelings of tiredness & being 'down'.

09.08.14

- Subjective:** Complains of dizziness and reports two recent 'blackouts' (a few minutes each). Feels stressed - busy at work. Mood up and down since last visit. Reports tingling in hands. L leg still feels weak. Breathless, occasional constipation, short of energy. Has been trying to eat better & exercise more - walks (30mins) x2-3/week. Still smoking.
- Examination:** BP: 88/70, HR: 76bpm
BMI: 28 (Wt: 93.7kg)
Chest clear
Loss of sensation on L & R hands (sharp/blunt)
Reflexes - diminished L patellar reflex
- Tests:** Order head & lumbar spinal CT to try to determine cause(s) of leg weakness and associated objective hyporeflexia (?central or spinal — check for spinal cysts/ tumours, etc.).
- Assessment:** ?multiple sclerosis
- Plan:** Order CT
Refer to neurologist: a full neurological assessment; ?order MRI

Writing Task:

Using the information given in the case notes, write a letter of referral to Dr M McLaren, Neurologist, Suite 3, 67 The Crescent, Newtown.

In your answer:

- Expand the relevant notes into complete sentences
- Do not use note form
- Use letter format

The body of the letter should be approximately 180–200 words.